

Interview Notes - Mother of three in Kibera

1. Can you describe your current experience with purchasing nutrient-dense foods? What challenges do you face in accessing these foods, especially in urban areas?

As a mother of three in Kibera, getting nutrient-dense foods is always a struggle. Most nearby kiosks sell maize flour, rice, and cooking oil, but rarely fresh vegetables, milk, or eggs. Prices at supermarkets are too high, and when I go to the market, it takes a lot of time. The biggest challenge is that even when I find these foods, I cannot afford enough to feed my children regularly.

2. How do you typically decide where to buy your food? What factors influence your choice between traditional purchasing methods and digital delivery options?

I buy mostly from the kiosks close to my house because they give me food on credit when I have no money. Sometimes, I go to Toi Market for lower prices, but only when I can spare transport fare. Digital delivery is not an option for me because I don't have enough data bundles and I prefer to touch and see the food before buying.

3. Have you ever used a digital platform to purchase food? If so, what was your experience like, and if not, what has prevented you from trying it?

I have never used one. The main reason is cost and lack of trust. I fear that food may arrive spoiled, or the quantity might be less than promised. I also don't have a smartphone suitable for those apps.

4. If a digital delivery service offered nutrient-dense foods at a price 10% lower than your usual purchasing method, how would that impact your decision to use it?

I would think about trying it, especially if it saved me time. But I would want assurance that food quality is good, delivery is on time, and there are no hidden charges.

5. What are your thoughts on the affordability of nutrient-dense foods? How much are you willing to pay for these foods, and what would make you feel that the price is fair?

Right now, the price of eggs or milk is too high. If eggs were 10 shillings instead of 18 or 20, I could buy them more often. Fair prices mean being able to buy enough for all my children at least twice a week without skipping other meals.

6. Can you describe your current experience with purchasing small dried fish or liver? What challenges do you face when trying to buy these foods?

Small dried fish is sometimes available but often not fresh, and liver is expensive. I can only buy liver once or twice a month. The main challenge is freshness and cost.

7. How do high food prices impact your family's ability to access nutritious foods? Can you share specific examples of how this affects your daily meals?

Most days we eat ugali with sukuma wiki. Protein is rare. My children complain about eating the same thing daily, but with high prices, I cannot afford chicken, milk, or eggs regularly. Sometimes they only get tea without milk in the morning.

8. If a digital platform offered small dried fish and liver at lower prices, how likely would you be to use it? What features would be most important to you in such a platform?

I would be interested if the prices were lower and if I could pay in cash on delivery. Features like flexible payment and assurance of freshness would matter most.

9. What alternatives do you currently use to cope with high food prices? How effective are these solutions in meeting your family's nutritional needs?

I sometimes buy food on credit or borrow from neighbors. I also reduce portion sizes so that food lasts longer. But these solutions are not effective—children still lack variety.

10. Would you be willing to pay a small fee for the convenience of ordering affordable, nutrient-rich foods online? What price range would you consider acceptable?

If it saved me transport costs and time, maybe 20 to 30 shillings per order. Anything higher would be too much.

11. Can you describe your current experience in accessing nutrient-dense foods for your children? What challenges do you face in this process?

My biggest challenge is consistency. I can sometimes buy milk and eggs, but not regularly. It hurts me when my children ask for these foods and I cannot provide.

12. How do you currently ensure that your children have a diverse diet? What strategies do you use to overcome the limitations you face?

I try to mix vegetables like sukuma wiki with tomatoes or onions when I can afford them. Sometimes I cook beans, but it takes long and uses a lot of fuel. Variety is limited.

13. What types of foods do you wish were more accessible or affordable for your family, and why are these important for your children's health?

Eggs, milk, fruits, and fish. These foods are important for children's growth and health. My youngest child is underweight, and the doctor recommended more protein.

14. If a digital delivery service offered affordable, nutrient-dense foods, how likely would you be to use it? What factors would influence your decision to try such a service?

I would likely try it if prices were truly lower, food was fresh, and I could pay after delivery. Trust and affordability are the key factors.

15. What would you be willing to pay for a service that significantly improved your children's dietary diversity? Can you explain your reasoning behind that amount?

Maybe 100 shillings per month, if it meant my children could eat eggs or milk at least twice a week. I cannot pay more because of my low income.